Building disciples of Jesus Christ

Ben intentionally incorporates the gospel into class instruction including class discussions and content, coursework, and interactions with students. Ben openly and consistently shares his testimony with students and discusses gospel centered questions. Brother Pacini is specific in sharing with his students how Teaching in the Savior's Way is central to his instructional design and teaching. Ben consistently helps students with personal questions related to the gospel. Ben encourages students to watch Devotional with him and hold a discussion immediately following devotional to share takeaways, deepen understanding, and build students' testimonies. Ben wrote and published an article in BYU-Idaho's perspective magazine. The article addressed how Ben incorporates the gospel into his teaching and supports gospel principles as he maintains an environment that shows the love of Christ towards all students.

Efforts of being progressive and effective teacher

Ben actively seeks out opportunities and resources to help him learn and grow as a teacher. Ben seeks out current research related to teacher development and innovative practices. He uses the insights and learning gained to improve his teaching skills. Ben intentionally incorporates humor into instruction, building relationships with students as he creates interest in learning. In response to BYU-Idaho's focus on cognitive science related to learning, Ben intentionally planned retrieval practice into his courses, leveraging technology to deepen recall and develop associations between concepts.

In another instance, Ben used carefully crafted questions to help students delve into higher order thinking, explain to students this was done intentionally to assist them in thinking deeply and reaching their potential. Ben encourages his students to grapple with questions and seek answers. Brother Pacini designs instruction that provides time for students to talk through and construct their own understanding. Ben is able to create relevance in the concepts learns as he shares his teaching and administrative experiences with students, bridging theory to practice. Students in Ben's courses are engaged and interact at high levels with the content, their peers, and Brother Pacini.

In addition to participating in opportunities to learn about teaching, Ben has also contributed to the growth and learning of other faculty members related to teaching and learning. Ben has been influential in helping others learn and incorporate mastery learning into their course design through campus presentations and collaborative efforts to assist faculty in learning about and implementing mastery-based learning into course design. Others seek out Ben as a resource for learning and teaching.

Student-focused involvement

Ben has a very student-focused approach to teaching, learning, and mentoring. Ben designs instruction that engages students in reflecting on their learning, deepening secular learning, and making connections to gospel principles while deepening their understanding of gospel principles. Brother Pacini has an open-door policy that is demonstrably more than a policy. Ben's office is a natural gathering place where students go to chat, explore their thinking, pose questions, and seek counsel. Ben willingly sets aside whatever he is doing to assist students. It is common to find Ben meeting with students who are exploring education as a major, considering graduate school, or delving into ideas to enrich the campus experience for all students.

Ben has demonstrated his commitment to student-focused involvement in his leadership role as the advisor for the Elementary, Early, and Special Education Society. Ben works well with the society student leaders to plan activities that are applicable to students. It is important to note that in his role as advisor, Ben provides students with the autonomy to develop and move forward with their ideas.

Currency in the discipline

Brother Pacini consistently seeks out current research and thinking to further his own understanding and thinking about education and teacher preparation. Ben is pursuing his doctorate in educational leadership from Brigham Young University and is currently conducting research related to the discipline of teacher education. Ben is formulating a study that is relevant to Brigham Young University-Idaho and will utilize campus data to explore how to improve leaning for students. Ben is a deep thinker and a prolific and masterful writer. Ben uses his writing skills to share his learning and involve others in exploring current thinking within the field of education as an avenue to posit new theories with the potential to influence practice. Ben is a self-motivated learner who has demonstrated his commitment and passion for research and learning.

Collegiality and service within in the department, college, or university

Ben's service reach is felt across campus. As previously mentioned, Ben serves as the advisor for the department student society. He also participates regularly and consistently program collaboration meetings and Portfolio Reviews. Ben has contributed to the scholarship of teaching and learning in an article he authored that was included in *Perspectives* magazine. Ben has been a leader in teaching others and helping them implement mastery learning in their course design. Ben has led brown bag presentations on mastery learning, creating greater interest in helping elevate the student learning experiences in colleges throughout campus.

In response to questions from students, Ben proposed, organized, and moderated a panel discussion about the Ukraine/Russia conflict. Ben was tireless in his efforts to ensure panel members represented a wide variety of experiences and provided a balanced view of the Ukrainian conflict. The discussion was well attended and provided a powerful learning experience for students and faculty alike.

Helping to forward the mission of the University

Ben has dedicated his time and talent to developing disciples of Christ with strong communication, collaboration, and thinking skills. Ben's efforts to the department and campus at large are significant and appreciated.